

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 18

KENTUCKY

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Kentucky's family courts and child-welfare system.

107

KENTUCKY FAMILIES ON RECORD · 202 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 13 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 29, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
46 OF 120

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · KENTUCKY

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Kentucky. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Kimberly Blair Walson

JUDGE · CLARK · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Bias, took kids over unrelated incidents to child safety, didn't let me speak and hear my evidence. Biased, didn't hear evidence but from one party, delayed reunification, took children over allegations"*

> *"I have been told by both attorneys and others that she is "very tough" on "alcoholics" because she "grew up with an alcoholic father" Does not require any proof from other party. Very biased."*

> *"Biased, immediately gave my kids to other party without prior reasons Biased, delayed reunification, ignored evidence"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ky-kimberly-walson/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Dewana McLean

CPS WORKER · CLARK · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Lied in petitions, biased. Didn't investigate properly, favored mom over dad despite same allegations in both homes."*

> *"Biased, didn't properly investigate Falsifying documents"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ky-dewana-mclean/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

KENTUCKY AT A GLANCE.

Across 107 Kentucky families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
202
106 of 107 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$97,000
median across 45 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
13
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
43.9%
47 of 107 who answered; 33 of 107 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
107	1.9	106 of 107	46

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Kentucky families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF KENTUCKY FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	59	$8,000	$76,554	$4,516,660
Lost Wages	49	$8,000	$54,553	$2,673,101
Other Court Fees	38	$1,000	$14,426	$548,199
Therapy / Evaluations	46	$1,025	$9,033	$415,533
Reunification Services	30	$275	$5,708	$171,250
GAL Fees	39	$1,000	$6,114	$238,450
Asset Loss [1]	37	$20,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (45 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$97,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($20,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost	13	1.1 yrs
Mean months lost	32	2.7 yrs
Total across all families	2,666	222.2 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · KENTUCKY

Most families documenting in Kentucky are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	50	47%
Not provided	19	18%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	14	13%
Case closed: within last 2 years	12	11%
Active case: progress being made	7	7%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	70	65%
Family Court Only	22	21%
Unknown	9	8%
CPS Only	5	5%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)	1	1%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	18	17%
5 – 10 years	17	16%
6 months – 1 year	17	16%
Less than 6 months	16	15%
Over 10 years	15	14%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	30	28%
Visitation Only	22	21%
50/50 Joint	20	19%
Children in Foster Care	14	13%
Full Custody	12	11%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Jefferson	12	14%
Fayette	7	8%
Clark	5	6%
Campbell	3	4%
Pulaski	3	4%
Rowan	2	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	33	31%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	26	24%
Other	14	13%
High Conflict Divorce	7	7%
Environmental/Poverty-Related (Lack of housing, utilities, etc.)	5	5%

05 PARENT VOICES — KENTUCKY

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Kentucky comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *GALs or any third party appointed personnel cannot legally force you to pay for their services without a contract. Most are wholly inadequate to provide therapeutic or decide any sort of attachment bond between your and your children. Attorneys are not better parents or mental [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

They ignored my children being sexually abused by my family because they all know each other. They completely ignored all the evidence and won't terminate grandparents rights. Took my children when nothing was wrong.

— KENTUCKY PARENT · SHANNA

MORE VOICES FROM KENTUCKY

They have destroyed my children and family. They almost took my and their father's life

— PAMELA

In East KY, stands a judge who "fights" abuse by keeping kids there, where small town politics rule not truth and evidence. Our child, is a victim, the people meant to protect are actively hurting him.

— JOHN

Protected my abuser while causing me and my children more trauma.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has destroyed the lives of me and my children. My children currently live with their abusive father and I have no contact.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Forever traumatized and changed. My relationship with my kids will never be the same.

— STEPHANIE

removed the children from the mother to place with the father that made the false allegations.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Undoubtedly the removal and separation of my children had caused more trauma than accused. Resulting in a lifetime of distrust for govt entities, ptsd, self worth, etc. I am still singlehandedly on a daily basis trying to regain stability and peace of mind for us all.*
>
> — RAVEN

Allow me to escape a burning building but I have to send my children back every week. Now his abuse has shifted to be undetected.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lied, controlled and destroyed in every way possible. I'm not sure why they decided to target me and my kids

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system is broken, it's destroyed 4 children's lives

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated from my child, rights violated, denied due process, caused emotional trauma to my child and myself. We have missed 9 months of our lives.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I don't even care what they done to me. They nearly destroyed my child's life. They've destroyed the lives of so many children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has been verg detrimental to my children's mental, emotional, physical wellbeing, as well as mine.

— SAMANTHA

absolutely ripped my children away due to another person while i was at work

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ive been slandered, harassed and stripped of my parental rights by the courts. Ive been mentally abused by the system to the point of being suicidal. Thats just the tip of the iceberg.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *The Family Court has destroyed my entire life, separated me from my children and I was their primary caregiver, litigated me into destitution and I am at imminent risk to lose my home from delays and stalling. The judge is incompetent. Opposing counsel is now an accomplice- if [...]*
>
> — JENIFER

It has caused severe trauma and loss, emotionally and financially for my family. The excessive stress has also manifested as physical illness.

— VIVIAN

The system has mentally and emotionally abused my children. Broken families and it affects everyone

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system ruined my life and stole my relationship with my children, completely

— KEVIN

This wicked system has stolen something priceless that my son and I can never get back. It has inflicted trauma and irreparable harm for no legitimate reason. This injustice is inhumane.. we feel like we are in the twilight zone.

— EMILY

Tore our family apart. Broken our children

— ASHLEY

Destroyed us, mentally, emotionally & financially!

— BRITNY

“The system has emotionally drained us.” The system took my baby when I fought so deeply.”

— TRAVONNA

They destroyed me and my family

— DANNY

My daughter is traumatized 0my whole family is, she believes shes never coming home and wants to give up

— VELENA

‘Through prolonged delays, silenced voices, blocked access to the courts, and unchecked power, the system dismantled our family not by justice, but by process—leaving my children separated and a parent unheard.’

— JESSICA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They have destroyed us me and my kids are so close and now they are in therapy and crying to come home the courts don't give a damn about these kids just their pockets*
>
> — MORGAN

CPS didn't just intervene in my family, they disrupted our bond, our stability, and our ability to heal together.

— SAMANTHA

"I believed asking for help was an act of strength. I never imagined it would become the reason my family was torn apart."

— JOSLYN

The family court system has destroyed my and my daughter's life as we knew it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The kids and I are afraid to seek assistance, and fear CPS involvement in any matter. A total loss of faith in the system to protect the kids and parent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As long as an abuser has funds available, then the other parent and the child both will continue to pay the cost.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It destroys a person and health and emotions etc.

— HALLIE

I'm walking a very lonely path. My hope is that one day the system can protect the protective parent and stop violating our rights

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I will sit up to be arrested by my family on the restitution charge that I had already paid. Nobody came and got my children at the very rest so they put them in foster care for dependency. I have now completed my case plan and they still will not give me my kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Seeing how my family, CPS, the school system, everyone that my children and I was supposed to trust has let us down! And they can't say it was not done on purpose because every bit of it was intentional! They all lied on the report, on paper, under oath and kidnapped my children [...]*
>
> — TAWNYA

My relationship with my childs father has been destroyed. My relationship with my family has also been obliterated because of cps and the courts playing us against each other.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatized my kids, their therapist stated she needed to teach my 10yo to be a survivor, to be able to survive the abuse by his dad bc the court keeps giving him unsupervised visitation. Medical issues, anxiety, ptsd, issues with schools that were supposed to be their safe [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Severed what was a strong bond between my children, myself, and my fiancéeI. Prevented healthy discussion and understanding for my kids to understand that they were not abandoned by me and that this is not a reflection of their worth.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Im still in therapy. Now in spravato and emdr, my youngest has abandonment issues and major anxiety, now pooping his pants, he has major separation anxiety from me. My older sons were completely brain washed. My ex now has control over their minds as well as they are very [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed me on the inside for years. I struggled with mental disorders like depressing and others. I still owe 10 k in child supprt even though she lmoved in with me at the age of 18.....her mother lied about money I paid in. Like in the thousands before supprt got put [...]

— CODY

Creating turmoil where there wasn't any. Maddening progress that wears you down until you feel like leaving this earth. Never give up

— AMBER

The system has been nothing but destructive force in our lives. The harm will never be fully repaired.

— JASON

There is no constitutional reason to remove a parent from a child. All allegations of child abuse should be tried in criminal court, perjury should carry a high price. Abolish this Racketeering across our country.

— JESSICA

66 Kentucky parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 46 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — KENTUCKY

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Kentucky families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> They ignored my children being sexually abused by my family because they all know each other. They completely ignored all the evidence and won't terminate grandparents rights. Took my children when nothing was wrong.
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> — SHANNA

> GALs or any third party appointed personnel cannot legally force you to pay for their services without a contract. Most are wholly inadequate to provide therapeutic or decide any sort of attachment bond between your and your children. Attorneys are not better parents or mental health providers, and the majority of "therapists" are not qualified for high conflict cases, especially if alienation or attempts at false abuse allegations are made. Judges who sign off on motions without due process hearings from these self appointees are lazy and incompetent. Please find a new job, this is not a good fit for you.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> They have destroyed my children and family. They almost took my and their father's life
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> — PAMELA

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Im still in therapy. Now in spravato and emdr, my youngest has abandonment issues and major anxiety, now pooping his pants, he has major separation anxiety from me. My older sons were completely brain washed. My ex now has control over their minds as well as they are very misbehaved and prior to this my middle.son was about to be baptized. We were active in church, not now. My oldest quit all sports. I cant say anything without my kindness being taken out of context that I want my ex back. I cant have our oldest sons location hes now a driver but im not allowed to because my ex says I want her location and the judge said I have to have permission. We cant even co parent at this pointm she still harassed me. I can't even move on in a relationship she gets involved or starts messagaing.she involved and turned my whole family all our friends and my town against me which I was a major asset to this community she has ruined my life and totally changes the structure of our children's lives they have lived for over 10 years.... well simply because she has a new boyfriend. And ahe also did this to her ex husband prior to me... which the courts new! He became a drunk i believe now because of her control and narcissistic behaviors as well as her BPD he took off and left his oldest 2. Which is how I have 3.yes I adopted her kids 1 year prior to her then taking them... she wanted child support.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— JESSICA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Stole precious time, created permanent psychological scars that can heal but will never go away, and completely broke our trust in the government.

— DEIDRA

System failed me. Removed my son after 7 years of being sole custody caring parent. Court actors played together to corrupt the system. I lost 18 months parenting time. I want to expose them all so no parent go through this ever again !

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Evidence was suppressed, profits maximized at the expense of 3 children's precious bond with their mother. Drug addict, batterer given full custody even after he let our baby overdose on his drugs and she needed narcan to survive death. He didn't pay child support and harassed me for years prior.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We r living in family court hell

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Withheld granddaughter from her family other sister because of lies. Wouldn't let granddaughter be with her sister because I (grandmother) exposed cps 2 years sooner .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore us apart forever

— RICHARD

The system has accepted my ex wife's EPO against me for her and the children that was written in retaliation for me being done with her after 17 years of trying. It's been 8 months of the system separating me from my 5 children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

scared our minds forever,family problems with inlaws too much too list

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed. My sons are now brainwashed and alienated from me when I was the one accused of coaching and alienating them from their father because the didn't want to live with him.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cause great damage. These people do not know what they are doing....

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

removed me from my children's daily lives during the exact years their clinical records now show caused them measurable, documented harm: separation trauma, maximum-score separation anxiety, and a mood disorder diagnosed by two independent licensed clinicians who both concluded the cause was the separation itself, not my conduct. Every month I was restricted to supervised visitation while that unamended registry KARES listing cost me employment and income was a month my children went without their mother during a period that cannot be recovered — and the record of what that absence did to them is now in signed clinical notes from providers who had no connection to this case and no reason to reach any conclusion except the one the evidence gave them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my relationship with my children, used me for title four funding as a baby, then targeted my children because they knew I had no family. My six year old daughter (who i am just fine to parent) doesn't know her siblings, and they have been turned against me. Its like experiencing pain and hunger for 10 years straight with no relief in sight.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This whole situation has severely impacted my child's wellbeing. It has drained me emotionally and financially. It had caused me to have sleepless nights, missed work and emotionally damaged me

— ABIGAIL

No steps towards reunification with my children despite completing my case plan for over a year. Visits have stayed at minimum since they were taken 2 hours every other week, I've requested increased visitation and in-home visitation supervised or unsupervised. Called urgent care with no release of information signed, violating my privacy.

— SARAH I

Can't sleep, can't eat,worried sick. I'm 54 and just want to enjoy being a grandparent. No one listening to my side except state police defective Mathew Barham who has closed criminal side with no charges against daughter

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system is mom and dad

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My own government destroyed my family. My ow government forever altered the trajectory of my daughter's future and happiness. She will forever carry the scars from this horrific ordeal. This has dimmed the light of a very beautiful and once bright light. We have lost moments and experiences in which should be criminal and of the highest offenses. We cannot let this continue.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have no faith in the system. My son is now 34. He returned at 18 but is not the same. I've had more kids. The anxiety is unreal. I have attachment issues. I cant be hugged or touched without teasing. I am afraid to truly love them. I fear unexpected calls or knocks on the door. If they are late getting home I panic.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> The biggest losses we've been separated from the children continuously one of them hasn't spoken to us in over 5 years and she's now past the age of 18 thousands and thousands were spent for reunification everything was lost the home the children the business all equity and everything lost over 50 years old and trying to start from scratch it was moved to a new County and it's still going on who knows how many much more it's going to cost have to go prosane no money left
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

66 full approved Kentucky comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Kentucky report comes from Kentucky respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Kentucky — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 107 Kentucky families reporting here are not the universe of Kentucky families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

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